

Academic Appointments

Assistant Professor of Economics, University of Warwick

August 2024–

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Brown University	May 2024
Committee: John. N. Friedman, Peter Hull, Briank Knight.	
M.Sc. in Economics, Bocconi University	2018
B.Sc. in Economics, Bocconi University	2015
Exchange Program, Northwestern University	2014

Affiliations

ROCKWOOL Foundation Berlin, Research Affiliate	2025–
Institute of Fiscal Studies, Research Associate	2025–
J-PAL Invited Researcher, Jobs and Opportunity Initiative	2024–
AXA Research Lab on Gender Equality at Bocconi University External Fellow	2024–

Publications

Alfonsi, L., Namubiru, M., Spaziani, S., 2023. “Gender Gaps: Back and Here to Stay? Evidence from Skilled Ugandan Workers during COVID-19”. Review of Economics of the Household.

Spaziani, S., 2022. “Can Gender Quotas Break the Glass Ceiling? Evidence from Italian Municipal Elections”. European Journal of Political Economy.

Working Papers

“Optimal Unemployment Insurance Financing: Theory and Evidence from Two U.S. States” R&R, Quarterly Journal of Economics

“Meet Your Future: Experimental Evidence on the Labor Market Effects of Mentors” with Alfonsi L. and Namubiru M. Conditionally accepted based on pre-results review. Journal of Development Economics.

Selected Work in Progress

“Designing Severance Insurance: Theory and Evidence from Ethiopia”. With G. Abebe, S. Caria, F. Gerard, and L. Hensel. Conditionally accepted based on pre-results review. Journal of Development Economics.

“Labor Market Effects of Incomplete Wage Taxation” With J. Gruber and A. Guo

“Women for Women? From Political Representation to Impact in Italian Regions” With G. Conti, G. Facchini and F. Marazzi

Fellowships and Awards

American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, Excellence in Reviewing Award	2025
Honorable Mention, W.E. Upjohn Institute for Employment Research Dissertation Award [Link]	2024
Honorable Mention, Outstanding Doctoral Dissertation in Government Finance and Taxation [Link]	2024
Runner-up, Doctoral Dissertation Prize, Associazione Italiana di Valutazione	2024
Etta Chiuri Prize, Società Italiana di Economia Pubblica [Link]	2023
Graduate Students Teaching Award, Brown University	2020, 2023
Merit Dissertation Fellowship, Brown University	2023
Stone Inequality Initiative Fellowship	2022
Graduate Program in Development Fellowship, Watson Institute of Public and International Affairs	2021
Distinction Letter, Northwestern University	2014

Grants

Orlando Bravo Center for Economic Research Award - \$5,500	2021-2023
Watson Institute Graduate Program in Development Summer Funds -\$3,000	2021, 2023
Economics Department Award, Brown University - \$2,850	2020
JPAL Post Primary Initiative, Co-PI - \$49,178	2020
IZA: Gender, Growth Labour Markets in LICs Programme, Co-PI - £9,149	2020

Seminars and Conferences

- 2026** ROCKWOOL Foundation Berlin, SEHO Conference University of Pavia*, Diversity and Human Capital Workshop University of Exeter*
- 2025** Workshop on Gender Inequality: Navigating New Frontiers and Paradigm Shifts at LSE (invited discussant), ENS Lyon, AXA Gender Lab at Bocconi University, Bristol Applied Economics Meeting on Gender, Diversity and Human Capital, 2nd GEP Labour and Globalisation Workshop on Firms, workers, and inequality at the University of Nottingham (invited discussant), Stone Centre Conference on Optimal Taxation and Policy Design at UCL (invited discussant)
- 2024** EEA-ESEM, SIEP, AIEL, Brookings New Doctoral Research in Tax Policy & Public Finance, NTA (presenter + invited discussant), University of Pittsburgh, APPAM, FROGEE and SITE Conference: “How does gender matter in the economy?” Job Market: EIEF, Tor Vergata, CEMFI, UC Riverside, University of Warwick, Institute for Fiscal Studies, IIES, Aix-Marseille School of Economics, Bank of Italy, UAB Economics and Economic History, UAB Applied Economics, Bilkent University
- 2023** NTA, SIEP, Central Bank of Ireland, IIPF (presenter + discussant)
- 2022** NBER Behavioral Public Economics Bootcamp (attendee)
- 2021** NEUDC (presenter + discussant), LEAP-Bocconi Alumni Reunion

Professional Service

Referee: American Economic Review, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, Economic Development and Cultural Change, Empirical Economics, European Journal of Political Economy, International Tax and Public Finance, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Population Economics, Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics, Oxford Development Studies, Political Science Research and Methods, The Economic Journal

Grant Reviewer: National Science Foundation

Conference Re-viewer: European Association of Young Economists Annual Meeting

Department Service: Member of the Departmental Working Group on Teaching Strategy (Vision, Educational Goals, Curriculum Design, Teaching methods, and Innovation), Warwick, 2025-2026; Member of the Junior Hiring Committee, Warwick, 2024-2025; Organizer of the Applied Micro Breakfast, Brown, 2022-2023.

Teaching

Instructor, University of Warwick

Principles of Political Economy: Economics and Politics - Undergraduate, PPE Fall 2025

Public Economics - Graduate, Economics Winter 2025

Teaching Assistant, Brown University

Mathematical Econometrics I - undergraduate, (*Professor: Peter Hull*) Fall 2021, 2022

Microeconomics II - PhD Sequence, (*Professors: Kareen Rozen and Glenn Loury*) Spring 2020

Designing Internet Marketplace - undergraduate (*Professor: Bobby Pakzad-Hurson*) Fall 2019

Other Writing

“When the Great Equalizer Closes” G²LMLIC Policy Brief No. 38, with L. Alfonsi and M. Namubiru [\[Link\]](#)

Prior Employment and Affiliations

Population Studies and Training Center, Brown University, Affiliated Student 2019-2024

Watson Institute for International and Public Affairs, Brown University, Affiliated Student 2019-2024

Laboratory for Effective Anti-Poverty Policies, Bocconi University, Affiliated Student 2017-2024

IGIER, Bocconi University, Affiliated Student 2016-2018

Bocconi University, Research Assistant for Eliana La Ferrara 2017-2018

BRAC Uganda Research and Evaluation Unit, Field Assistant 2016

SEI Consulting, Intern 2015

Updated on April 15, 2026